MAUS

Details **Originally published** Maus (1980-91) **Publisher** Raw Books & Graphics/Penguin Books (original), Pantheon Books (graphic novel) **Writer** Art Spiegelman **Artist** Art Spiegelman **Collected in** Maus **Available digitally** Penguin

Maus is often described as one of the greatest graphic novels of all time, and rightly so. Its depiction of what Spiegelman's Jewish parents suffered during the Holocaust examines in heart-rending depth how we relate to the people who make our histories.

Spiegelman uses animal masks to denote different people groups – for instance, the Jews wear mouse masks, while the Nazis wear cat masks – suggesting that national, ethnic and religious uniformity is somewhat artificial, raising the question of whether any history can be shared. Meanwhile, Spiegelman struggles to reconcile his respect for his father's refusal to be defeated with the frustration he feels towards him in everyday life.

Maus's excellence lies in these conflicts, exploring the nature of collective identity and the burden of history in a way that no other graphic novel does.







